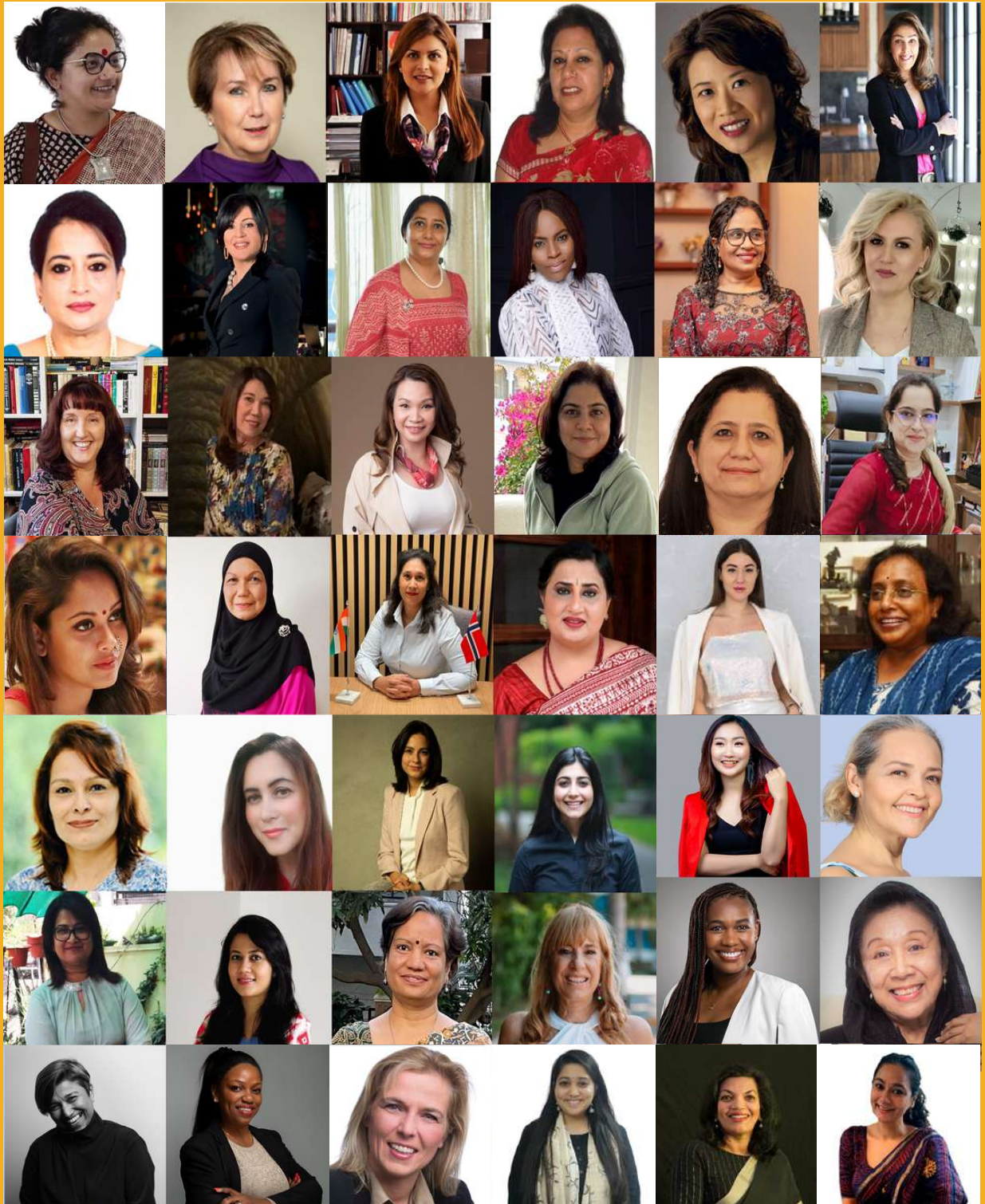


ABWCI



ROUNDUP

APRIL 2023

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Message From Our Founder Secretary General

The business landscape is rapidly evolving, and attitudes towards traditional business practices are changing along with it. While there is evidence of women playing a prominent role in shaping the future of business, it is still apparent that women's inequality is a significant problem in the business world.

According to GEM's 2021/2022 Women's Entrepreneurship Report, one-third of high-growth businesses worldwide are now run by women.



PARUL SONI

However, one of the most concerning issues surrounding women in business is the lack of funding that female entrepreneurs often face. For instance, data suggests that only two percent of all UK venture funding goes to all-female teams. Therefore, much more needs to be done to ensure that women not only have equal opportunities to start their own businesses but also feel empowered enough to do so.

The ABWCI team and I are extremely thankful to all our partners for their constant encouragement and support of ABWCI and women's entrepreneurship. We look forward to your continued support as we are committed to redefining the entrepreneurial ecosystem for women. We invite you to join this growing community of passionate, influential, and successful women in business.

■ Taking Charge ■

ABWCI's Leadership Womenforce



Dr. Ambika Sharma
Chief Executive Officer



Ms. Savita Sethi
Chief Operating Officer



Message From Our Ambassadors

#MenWhoSupportWomen



FRITS BUSSEMAKER

**Chairman,
Institute for Accountability
in the Digital Age**

I have a great belief in the power and potential of women, having invested a lot of time in fostering business communities and discussing the transition from a Command-and-Control to a Connect-and-Collaborate model. That is, we are switching from silos to a single network. This applies to the society itself. So, individuals should step out of their silos and ask what they have in common, how they complement each other. I aim to use my community-building experience to strengthen the global entrepreneurship ecosystem and make it inclusive and equal for all.



ALEXANDER WOOD

**Chief Executive Officer,
AWR Lloyd**

I have lived in Asia for over two decades and have always been in awe of the courage, resilience, work ethic and creativity of Asian women. There is no doubt in my mind that Shakti is 'real' and that unleashing the magic that women bring to free enterprise is critical to global sustainable economic growth. It is a true honor to have been invited to become a Global Ambassador at ABWCI. I will strive to work closely with the Association's leadership and to engage the expertise of my colleagues at AWR Lloyd to launch innovative new programs for empowering businesswomen throughout Asia and beyond.



ODINO FACCIA

**President, "Voice for Peace
in the World" and Italian-
Argentine Singer**

Being able to break inequality is generating the same rights for men and women, which also has to do with social justice and political decisions. There is a system that reinforces the maintenance of the unequal structure, that is why it is so important to deepen equality of rights and opportunities, no one is more than anyone, neither higher nor lower, we are all exactly the same, especially when the equalities of opportunities are reflected in the conditions and capacities, without differentiating ethnic groups, color or sex.

Introducing Our Presidents

#WomenLeadingChange



CAMELIA YAACOB
Country President,
Malaysia

Camelia joined ABWCI as a Global Ambassador and has now taken dual charge as the Country President for Malaysia. She has two decades of operational and management expertise under her belt. She is a self-made successful serial-entrepreneur who has developed a sharp eye for how businesses and organizations can get plugged with low returns due to business decision inefficiencies and lack of desire to invest or learn marketing. She founded Rootwommers Sdn Bhd in 2011 to help business owners accelerate in marketing their products professionally by using a specially designed original system in Word-of-Mouth Marketing.



JULIETA SILVA
Country President,
Mexico

Julieta can be best described as a visionary who is passionate about what she does and takes every challenge very seriously. Her willingness to learn and give it the best effort possible makes her an absolute choice for new challenges. She serves a non-profit organization called Care for Good-Life, as a member of the board. She supports the organisation by raising awareness and collecting donations for the care of the elderly and disabled in her local community. She is a true believer in the saying "Where there is a will, there is a way."



REFILWE MATENCHE
Country President,
South Africa

Refilwe is the founder and managing director of a boutique consulting firm, Thendo Consultants, that offers advisory solutions across sectors to create and/or support strategic advancement of women in corporate and business. She is also the founder of a non-profit for emerging women leaders, the African Women's Movement (AWM) that endeavors to be a change agent in the ongoing pursuit for equal opportunity and better representation of women in decision-making & industry leading spaces in Africa.

Introducing Our Presidents

#WomenLeadingChange



VIDYA MANMOHAN

Country President,
UAE

Vidya is known for creating her own version of a network agency that focuses on supporting talented women across the globe, whilst producing work for brands that lead by example. Vidya has also been on the jury of most International Advertising Festivals like the Cannes Lions, D&AD, One Show, New York Festivals, Clio, Adfest, Lisbon Advertising Awards, Loeries and the Young Guns to name a few.



EMELDA MWAMANGA

Country President,
Tanzania

Emelda is the CEO and Principal Consultant of Relim Company Limited, a Human Resources and Logistics Consulting firm, based in Tanzania, as well as the CEO of The East Africa Bang Media House which she started in 2004 with Bang! Magazine, a premier lifestyle magazine that captures inspiring stories of women overcoming odds to achieve success and impact. Emelda is also an honoree of numerous leadership recognition programs.

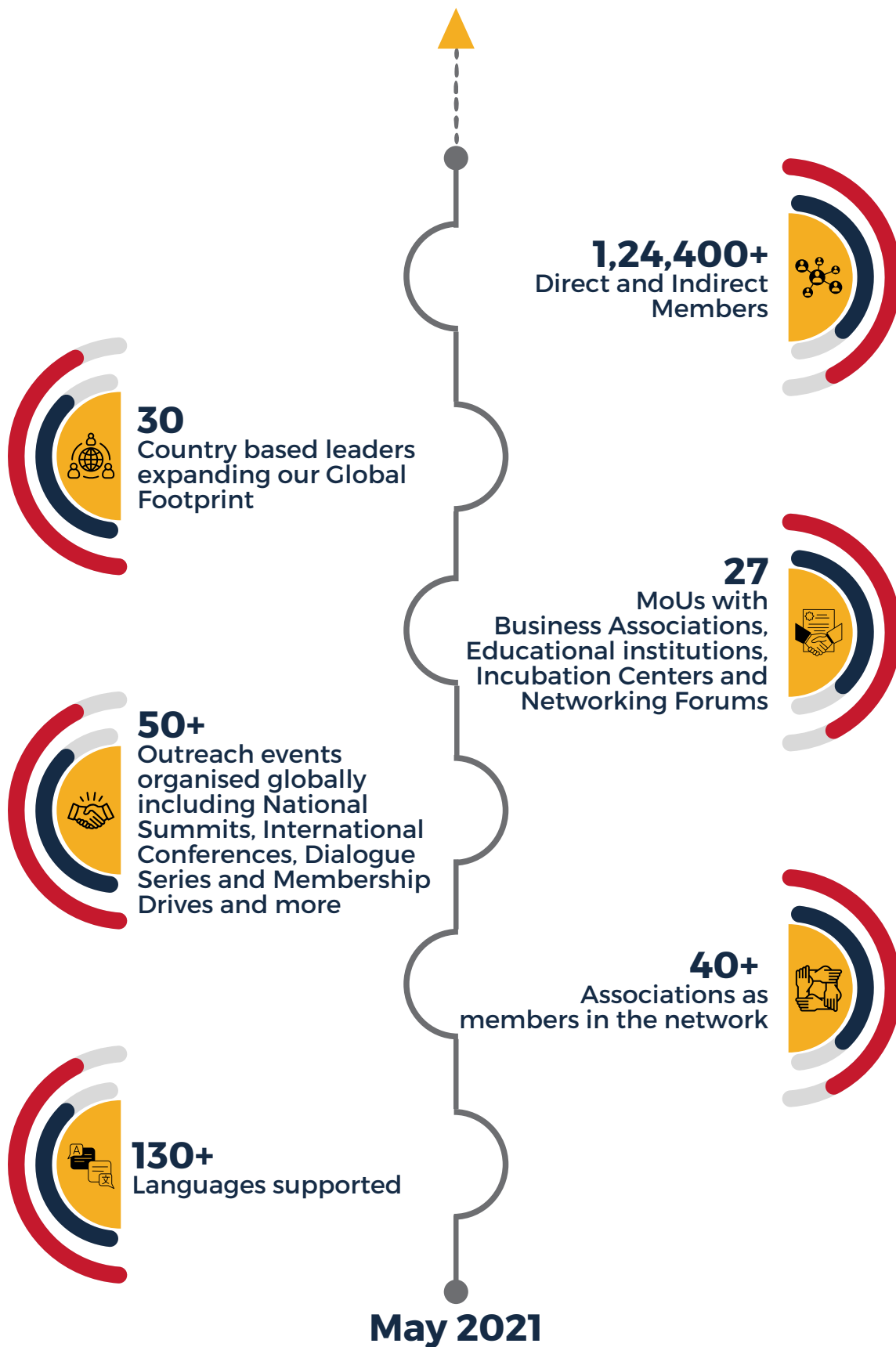


KAREN VAN DER ZANDEN

Country President,
Netherlands

Karen has held various executive management positions while working across countries and diverse industries. As an entrepreneur she has built the largest community of IT professionals in the Netherlands, serving big companies and large public organizations. She is an active member of the Rotary Foundation. She is also a board member and advisor at iPoort, a non-profit foundation to entertain the dialogue between Dutch Parliament members, Dutch companies and society regarding digitalization and new technologies.

The Journey Thus Far



ABWCI In Action



MALAYSIA

Networking High Tea

With the vision to enhance the outreach to thousands of women entrepreneurs in Malaysia, Camelia Yaacob who joined ABWCI as a Global Ambassador and has now taken dual charge as the Country President for Malaysia, organised a networking high tea for women entrepreneurs in Kuala Lumpur on April 08, 2023.



ARGENTINA

Concert for Peace and Values

Odino Faccia, Global Ambassador at ABWCI is on a journey to generate social change and highlight the importance of peace, harmony and unity in the world through his music. He is an Official Candidate for the 2023 Nobel Peace Prize and his 'Concert for Peace and Values' was organised on April 09, 2023 at the Belgrano Square, Buenos Aires, Argentina.



PHILIPPINES

International Women's Summit

ABWCI's Country President, Philippines, Phoebe G. David organised the International Women's Summit in Manila, Philippines on April 15, 2023. The summit received support from the Department of Trade & Industry, Government of Philippines and women entrepreneurs. With the delegations from Malaysia, Singapore, Indonesia, Bangladesh and leaders & members of ABWCI joining virtually from all across the globe, the summit was a huge success.





ABWCI In Action



NIGERIA

Sip and Munch

ABWCI's Country President, Nigeria, Ayodeji Megbope and her team with support from the members organised 'Sip and Munch', a networking meet-up for women entrepreneurs in Nigeria. The hybrid event was organised with the aim to establish a robust community of women entrepreneurs, so that they can build on each other's strengths and achieve greater heights together. This would lead to the creation of an entrepreneurial ecosystem that supports partnerships and collaborations.



SINGAPORE

HCBN Monthly Meeting

ABWCI's Country President, Singapore, Lilian Ong and her team at Her Courage BizNetwork (HCBN) organize meetings for the members of both ABWCI and HCBN on the first Tuesday of every month. The goal of HCBN is to create a support system where women entrepreneurs can find resources to grow their businesses and themselves as courageous leaders. The focus of these meetings is on themes like emotional intelligence, motivation, and leadership skills.



ABWCI In Action



INDIA

G20/W20 Inception Meeting

W20 is the official G20 engagement group focused on gender equity. Its primary objective is to ensure that gender considerations are mainstreamed into G20 discussions and translate into the G20 Leaders' Declaration as policies and commitments that foster gender equality & women's economic empowerment.

Ayodeji Megbope, Country President, Nigeria and Ayesha AKHTER, Member, Bangladesh represented ABWCI at the W20 Inception Meeting held in Aurangabad, India on February 26-27, 2023.

The focus of the deliberations was on the following thematic:

- Empowering Women in Nano, Micro, and Startup Enterprises
- Role of Women as Changemakers in Climate Resilience Actions
- Creating an Enabling Ecosystem for Women Leaders at the Grassroots
- Improving Access through Infrastructure & Skill to bridge the Gender Digital Divide
- Creating Pathways for Women through Education & Skilling
- Women-led Development in India
- Breaking the Barriers
- Enablers for Women-led Development: Policy and Legal Frameworks



ABWCI In Action



INDIA

G20/W20 Meeting in Jaipur

The mission of W20 is to remove all barriers to women led development and ensure an enabling environment and ecosystem for women to thrive, transcend and transform their lives as well as others.

W20 is one of the most important engagement groups under the G20 and is pivotal to enabling societal transformation and women-led development. The two-day meeting was themed, “Women-Led Development: Leveraging Women’s Untapped Potential to Accelerate an Inclusive and Sustainable Future”. Team ABWCI participated in the meeting, committing towards the evolution of development for women to women led development.



C20 Policy Dialogue

C20 India 2023 is one of the official engagement groups of the G20 that provides a platform for Civil Society Organizations (CSO) around the world to voice people’s aspirations to the world leaders in G20. It gives CSOs a forum to protect the agency of this sector, reflect the primary and common concerns affecting the people of the world, and to promote social and economic development with the vision of leaving no one behind.

Dr. Graciela De Oto, ABWCI's Country President, Argentina participated in the dialogue entitled 'Policy Dialogue on the Intricacies of the Social and Cultural Components of Gender Inequality'. The three themes covered in the dialogue were:

- Women’s role in leadership and governance
- Balancing gender roles in work and life
- Biases and stereotypes that perpetuate gender inequality



ABWCI In Action



INDIA

Hero for Humanity



In Partnership with Hero MotoCorp

Hero MotoCorp launched a project - 'Hero for Humanity' in different States of India to support the women who lost their husbands to COVID -19 pandemic (Project Beneficiaries) and their families.

ABWCI supported this initiative as the project implementation partner in the States of Odisha and Karnataka. The aim of the project was to extend sustenance support to the beneficiaries for a limited period of time, by providing ration and education support, and long term assistance for empowering them to take up sustainable livelihood alternatives.

Phase I of the project (6 months) focused on providing monthly grocery kits as basic sustenance support and educational support (For children above 5 years of age). A total of 300 project beneficiaries were selected from both the States.

Phase II entailed capacity building of the project beneficiaries, developing their skills and subsequently supporting them in setting up of enterprises for sustainable livelihood. 215 project beneficiaries of the above listed 300, were selected from Phase 1 of the project.



ABWCI In Action



INDIA



State-Level Consultation with Private Sector Partners for Mainstreaming and Integration of SDGs

In Partnership with UNDP India

The SDG 2030 agenda calls on businesses, ranging from microenterprises to multinational corporations, to apply their creativity and innovation for solving sustainable development challenges.

The half day consultation was designed as a series of panel discussions focusing on:

- Strengthening the Skill Development, Employment and Livelihood Ecosystem
- Sustainable Energy, Environment and Resilience
- Strengthening Start-up ecosystem with a focus on Technology and Innovation for social good

The sessions brought together key stakeholders from private sector and State Governments on a common platform to understand the development program implementation and their alignment with the UN's Sustainable Development Agenda 2030. The consultation concluded by exploring ways to collaborate and converge to address social challenges.





ABWCI Dialogues

Episode 12 is now available on YouTube!



The ABWCI Dialogue Series is aimed at creating a platform for stakeholders to understand the challenges and opportunities in an ever evolving ecosystem for women entrepreneurs. The goal of these discussions is to enable the exchange of best practices and success stories that have worked in different contexts and countries.

Each episode focuses on highlighting individual insights from an entrepreneur's journey - allowing the audience to engage and learn about the different entrepreneurial ecosystems in various countries and regions.

At ABWCI, we aim to leave behind a documented legacy of learning for the entrepreneurs of the future.

The episodes go live on both Zoom and YouTube, and all the episodes of ABWCI Dialogues are available on our YouTube channel.

 [CLICK HERE TO VISIT OUR YOUTUBE CHANNEL](#)

ABWCI Dialogues

LISTEN - LEARN - CONNECT

EPISODE - 11



Parul Soni

Founder Secretary General,
ABWCI



Pradnya Godbole

Chief Executive Officer,
deAsra Foundation

ABWCI Dialogues

LISTEN - LEARN - CONNECT

EPISODE - 10



Parul Soni

Founder Secretary General,
ABWCI



Lilian Ong

ABWCI's Country President,
Singapore

ABWCI Dialogues

LISTEN - LEARN - CONNECT

EPISODE - 09



Parul Soni

Founder Secretary General,
ABWCI



Dr. Graciela De Oto

ABWCI's Country President,
Argentina

ABWCI Dialogues

LISTEN - LEARN - CONNECT

EPISODE - 08



Parul Soni

Founder Secretary General,
ABWCI



Ayodeji Megbope

ABWCI's Country President,
Nigeria

Thursday | Feb 23, 2023 | 4 PM (IST) Onwards Thursday | Jan 19, 2023 | 4 PM (IST) Onwards Thursday | Dec 22, 2022 | 4 PM (IST) Onwards Thursday | Nov 17, 2022 | 4 PM (IST) Onwards

#ABWCIDIALOGUES

#ABWCIDIALOGUES

#ABWCIDIALOGUES

#ABWCIDIALOGUES

Our Partners



deAsra
Powering businesses. Creating jobs.



AWR Lloyd



[CLICK HERE TO ACCESS THE WEBSITE](#)

W20 is one of the most important engagement groups under the G20 and is pivotal to enabling societal transformation & women-led development. The vision of W20 is to create a world of equality & equity where every woman lives with dignity.

AWR Lloyd is a specialist strategy and M&A advisory firm focused on the Indo-Pacific region. The firm has a 23-year track record delivering bespoke strategic advice, M&A support and industry intelligence to some of the world's biggest and most successful companies.



AWR Lloyd

[CLICK HERE TO ACCESS THE WEBSITE](#)



[CLICK HERE TO ACCESS THE WEBSITE](#)

Win Win Women's mission is to help women worldwide excel personally and professionally, and we help experts share their solutions through live and on-demand shows and events.

deAsra is committed to enabling people to start, manage & grow a small business successfully. To this end, we offer a platform wherein, setting up, managing & growing a small business is made simple & entrepreneur friendly through a broad array of support services.



deAsra
Powering businesses. Creating jobs.

[CLICK HERE TO ACCESS THE WEBSITE](#)



[CLICK HERE TO ACCESS THE WEBSITE](#)

The NorthCap University (NCU) is a multidisciplinary university that operates four schools and benefits from a strategic collaboration which focuses on innovation, internationalization and digitization.



Financial Literacy

The term “financial literacy” refers to a variety of important financial skills and concepts. Financial literacy is understanding and effectively using various financial skills, including financial management, budgeting, and investing.

It's a financial planning tool utilized to achieve strategic long-term financial goals such as investments and debts, retirement plans, savings, responding to financial shocks, and running businesses. It is pivotal for women entrepreneurs to be financially literate as they struggle with less favorable conditions, pronounced cultural biases, and bigger financial challenges compared to men.



BHARAT SONI
Lead - Access to Finance
Global Secretariat
ABWCI

Entrepreneurs continue to face challenges – financial, technological, regulatory, social, capacity, and sustainability, these are further exacerbated for women entrepreneurs, leading to the failure of women-owned businesses and/or fewer initiation of businesses.

To overcome these challenges and run successful businesses, women entrepreneurs need to develop effective business plans and assess future demand wherein financial literacy plays a crucial role. Financial literacy helps women entrepreneurs in making informed financial decisions and efficiently managing businesses leading to improved financial results and outcomes. It is also an instrument to identify potential financial risks to businesses and formulate strategies to reduce financial risks during economic challenges and unexpected events. It gives women the negotiation skills to bargain for favorable terms, earn better profits, and make informed decisions related to credit and lending.

ABWCI offers various solutions to women entrepreneurs to improve their financial literacy. Women entrepreneurs can attain financial literacy and upskill themselves through the curated online courses, events, and knowledge and learning material available on the ABWCI virtual global platform.

Components of Financial Literacy

Budgeting

Saving

Investment

**Borrowing and
Debt Management**

Watch This Space

- **Explore Your Potential with Supriya Pujari:** ABWCI and Supriya's Life Coaching Centre are co-hosting a session on "Explore your Potential" this International Coaching Week. Join us on 11 May 2023 at 6 PM IST and move a step closer to knowing yourself better.
- **ABWCI Dialogues - Episode 13:** The next episode of ABWCI Dialogues is coming soon, subscribe to all our social media channels and stay tuned for updates.
- **Expert Series:** ABWCI's new series where experts from various industries share their advice on the best practices for entrepreneurs. Get to know industry insights from our experts onboard who guide and mentor women entrepreneurs globally.
- **WE Open Doors:** A new initiative by ABWCI, WE Open Doors will be a series of sessions focusing on networking & business matchmaking to promote and encourage women entrepreneurs, culminating in a pipeline of business opportunities globally.

**'WE' CAN
DO IT ALL!**



" Entrepreneurs have a natural inclination to do it alone. While this do-it-yourself spirit can help you move forward, adding an element of collaboration into the mix can make you unstoppable"

Leah Busque
Founder, Taskrabbit

CONTACT US

info@abwci.org



SCAN TO LEARN MORE

